

Figure 20.6 A call to a web API endpoint in an e-commerce ASP.NET Core web application. The ghosted portion of the diagram is identical to figure 20.5.

As before, the routing middleware selects an endpoint to invoke based on the incoming URL. For API controllers this is a controller and action instead of a Razor Page.

After routing comes model-binding, in which the binder creates a binding model and populates it with values from the request. Web API controllers often accept data in more formats than Razor Pages, such as XML, but otherwise the model-binding process is the same as for the Razor Pages request. Validation also occurs in the same way, and the `ModelState` property on the `ControllerBase` base class is populated with any validation errors.

NOTE Web APIs use *input formatters* to accept data sent to them in a variety of formats. Commonly these formats are JSON or XML, but you can create input formatters for any sort of type, such as CSV. I show how to enable the XML input formatter in section 20.6. You can see how to create a custom input formatter at http://mng.bz/e5gG.

The action method is the equivalent of the Razor Page handler; it interacts with the application model in the same way. This is an important point; by separating the behavior of your app into an application model instead of